



(ICPEN), for example, works to ensure minimum standards of consumer protection for cross-border purchases.

Providing services

Consumer rights apply just as much to services, such as a plumbing, hairdressing, and building, as they do to products. If you provide a service, you need to be aware of laws that demand certain basic standards, including reasonable care and skill, binding contracts, specified price, and delivery within

an agreed time frame. If you fail to deliver your service to the agreed standards, you may have to repeat the service or provide compensation.

A knowledge of consumer rights will highlight what protection you might need against any legal action, such as product liability insurance (see pp.94–95). It will also help you meet your customers' expectations. An issue that is fairly resolved may renew a customer's faith in your business.

“Treat the customer like you would want to be treated. Period.”

Brad Schweig, Vice-president of Operations, Sunnyland Patio Furniture

